

you'll see a list of various lighting conditions, such as sunny, cloudy, incandescent/tungsten, fluorescent, etc. Depending upon the lighting condition you are in, if you think the auto white balance is not doing a good enough job it is highly recommended you switch to one of these manual modes immediately.

It might happen that sometimes even the manual option may not give best results. In which case it is recommended to mess around with all the available options and see which one gives the best results. It is important to judge based on what you see with your eyes rather than what the camera thinks is right. If you think the manual options give a stronger and unnatural color cast then switch back to auto, even if the manual mode may seem appropriate for that lighting condition.

Focus mode

Focus mode lets you choose how the camera will focus. There is the usual Auto mode, which means the camera can now focus from its farthest to its closest focusing range automatically by judging the distance from the subject. The Macro mode lets you shoot close up objects with ease. Some cameras will let you get close to a subject even in Auto mode whereas some will require being switched to Macro mode to come within a certain distance from the subject.

The minimum distance you can have from a subject differs from camera to camera, with some letting you get very close and others choosing not to, even in macro mode. If you think you are not able to get very close to a subject, you should then take the photo from a distance the camera is comfortable with and then crop the image to get close to the subject.

Occasionally you will find a Landscape mode option, which puts the camera in a fixed focus mode set to infinity. If you're lucky, you might have a manual focus option on your phone, that lets you manually control the focusing distance to your liking.

On touchscreen phones, you can also tap on the screen to lock the focus at a particular point. In most cases this also locks the exposure at that point, especially if spot metering is selected. Some third party apps, however, will let you select different focus and exposure points.

It's important that you are always in the correct focusing mode for the situation and that the image is always properly focused before you hit the shutter. Nothing ruins an image more than the lack of proper focus.